

OPEN CAMERA

Unlock your phone camera's true potential with these 10 tips on how to use open camera

If you think that your phone's stock camera app can do a lot, you'll be surprised to learn that Android lets you do much more with the Camera2 API. Unfortunately, you'll have to download third party apps to fully experience the features your phone's camera is capable of.

Open camera is one such app that is completely free. It doesn't have ads and can be used without any in app purchases. So what can you do on Open Camera which cannot be done on your stock camera? Read on to find out:



Camera Stabilization

When you're shooting video everyday, you'd be lucky if you have a device that has image stabilization built in. For now, it is a feature reserved in the top flagship devices only. Open Camera cleverly implements camera stabilization by using the accelerometer to show you the angle at which the camera is tilted. You can use this virtual spirit level to adjust your grip so that the photos and videos you shoot are perfectly level. To use it, simply open up Open Camera and look for the readings on the bottom left corner of the screen.



Showing interface, stabilization, memory usage



Open Camera 01

Multimedia Tracking and Recommendations ...02

{ Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference. }



Detect faces and not objects!

You can enable face detection in the settings menu and let the camera focus on the faces that are recognized in the frame rather than having to manually select the focal points. This makes it easier to shoot portraits and not having to worry about the person going out of focus.



Use volume keys to take a picture!

Open Camera lets you customize the volume keys to perform various functions when using the app. You can head over to Settings>more camera controls and set the behav-

our for the volume keys. The volume keys can be used to take a photo, toggle video recording, adjust the focus, zoom in/out, change exposure level and toggle auto stabilization. So fly through the app with the volume controls to take better images, faster.



Control your camera with your voice

You can set the camera to automatically take a picture or start recording video when you say a trigger word such as "cheese" or set it respond to loud noises. You'll find this handy when trying to take a groupie or an usie.



Adjust audio sensitivity

Not all environments you record video in are the same, some might be more noisy than the others. Unless your phone's mic adapts automatically, you'll be left with extremely noisy or muffled audio recordings. To counter this, you can manually adjust the sensitivity of the microphone to best suit the environment you're recording

in. Head over to Audio control options to increase or decrease the sensitivity.



Lock photo/video orientation

When you're shooting video, the internet will collectively groan if you're shooting it in portrait. If you have a problem with the orientation when you rotate your device, you can lock the orientation to landscape regardless of how the device is oriented. Or you can always record in portrait and endure the collective hate. Set the orientation under "More camera controls" in settings.

